

Live Pitch Session: Rules for Shortlisted Teams

3 August 2026, online, 15 minutes per team

What to prepare in advance

1. Decide how you want to present the highlights of your engine to impress the judges within 8 minutes.
2. Keep your engine logged in and ready throughout your session. Judges may ask to see a specific part of your tool running during the interview. No extra time is built in for you to reconnect or get it ready.
3. Have ready before joining: your prototype environment logged in and ready to launch; the pitch deck, demonstration video, GitHub repository you submitted on 20 July, and your submitted output file (CSV/JSON) in case it is needed under paragraph 9.
4. Join the meeting at least 20 minutes before your scheduled slot. You will be placed in a waiting room; please remain there until the organizing team moves your team to the Judges Room. A team that is not present when called will be moved to the end of the room's schedule; a team that does not appear at all cannot be scored on the live pitching component (50 per cent of the final score).

Your session

5. The Live Pitch is a closed session, conducted in English. Only one team is present in each Judges Room at a time; no audience or observers are permitted. All team members may join. All team members must keep their cameras on throughout.
6. On entering the Judges Room, begin your presentation immediately.
7. Presentation (8 minutes): present highlights of your engine. You may choose what would be the best showcase of your engine within the allocated time. A warning is given at the 7-minute mark. At 8 minutes, the moderator will mute all team members to signal the transition to the Q&A.
8. Q&A (7 minutes, judge-led): Judges will question you and may ask you to run the prototype live on a specific case. A warning is given at the 6-minute mark. You will be removed from the meeting at 7 min, or earlier if the judges have no further questions.

If something goes wrong

9. Run fails during the presentation: There will be no time for you to rerun. Be prepared to explain what went wrong.
10. Screen sharing fails, or no live output is produced: post your live output file (CSV/JSON) in the meeting chat. The Q&A proceeds as normal.
11. Disconnection: a stable internet connection is your responsibility. If you cannot rejoin promptly, the next team will be called in. Your team will be present at the end of the room's schedule with the time remaining from your slot. For a team member disconnection, if a team member disconnects when he or she is answering a question, the other members shall continue to answer. The clock runs as normal and no spare.
12. The schedule is fixed: no session is extended, repeated, or rescheduled. Errors in your own engine are part of the assessment. Only a failure of the meeting platform itself is treated as an organizer-side issue; notify the moderator immediately.

Results

13. Your final result combines the assessment of your 20 July submission (50 per cent) and the live pitch on 3 August (50 per cent). Results will be announced on 5 August 2026. Please do not contact judges or secretariat before the results are announced.